PROMISE & PRACTICE · UNIT 3 · DEEP DIVE ASSIGNMENT

Opening Night at the Nickelodeon

Film viewing + cause-and-effect chain · Skill: Cause and effect

Name _____ **Period** _____ **Date** _____

WHAT I CAN DO TODAY

I can explain why the movies spread so fast, what changed because of them, and why some people wanted to control them.



Entrance of the Revelry Theatre, a moving-picture theater, probably Chicago — photograph, c. 1909, public domain (Library of Congress)

Directions

Go through the Nickelodeon deep dive first and watch the three film clips. Then answer each part.

1 Watch closely

Think about the three film clips in the deep dive.

How is the 1894 Sandow film different from The Great Train Robbery (1903)?

Why could someone who did not speak English still enjoy these films?

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2 Put the movies in order

Number the events from first (1) to last (6). Then check your work to see the years.

ORDER	EVENT
_____	The Great Train Robbery becomes a hit
_____	Edison's Kinetoscope peep-show machines open
_____	Chicago passes the first movie censorship law in the U.S.
_____	Films are projected on a big screen with the Vitascope
_____	Charlie Chaplin makes His New Job at Essanay in Chicago
_____	Storefront nickelodeons start spreading

3 Cause or effect?

The nickelodeon boom had causes and effects. Sort each statement.

	STATEMENT	A CAUSE OF THE BOOM	AN EFFECT OF THE BOOM
1	Tickets cost only five cents	☐	☐
2	Reformers pushed for censorship laws	☐	☐
3	Silent films needed no English	☐	☐
4	Chicago became a center for making and renting films	☐	☐
5	Workers had a little free time in the evenings	☐	☐
6	Immigrant families shared American movies and stars	☐	☐

4 Make your case

Was Chicago right to censor movies in 1907?

Claim

Evidence

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Counterargument

Finished? Turn in this paper the way your teacher asks.

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